AFRICAN INSTITUTE OF PROJECT ASSURANCE AND FORENSICS
AIPAF

CPAP Requirements

ASSURANCE

Certified Project Assurance Practitioner

The CPAP certifies competence to provide independent, forward-looking assurance: to review a project on behalf of those who sanction, finance, insure, or own it, and to advise them whether it can realistically deliver what it promised.

1. Routes to certification

The Institute recognises three routes. All converge on the same examinations and the same standard. No route bypasses the foundation or its ethics component.

ROUTE	FOR WHOM	REQUIREMENT
Professional route	Established practitioners from cognate fields: engineering, surveying, audit, law, project management, forensic accounting.	A recognised professional qualification, plus a minimum of five years' relevant experience with at least two at a senior level, then the Institute's examinations.
Graduate route	Graduates in relevant disciplines entering the profession.	A relevant degree, plus a minimum of three years' structured and supervised experience logged against the track competencies, then the examinations.
Experience route	Skilled practitioners without a formal cognate qualification but with substantial demonstrable practice.	A minimum of eight years' relevant experience, a portfolio of work assessed by the Institute, then the full examination sequence.

> The stated minimum years are thresholds, not entitlements. Meeting the years does not by itself satisfy the requirement if the logged competencies are not demonstrated.

2. Shared foundation examinations

All three foundation papers must be passed before any CPAP paper is attempted. A candidate who has already passed the foundation for another AIPAF credential does not repeat it.

PAPER	FORMAT	DURATION	PASS MARK
F1 Principles of Project Delivery	Multiple choice and short written answer	3 hours	50%
F2 Evidence and Method	Written answer and a short analytical exercise	3 hours	50%
F3 Professional Ethics and Independence	Scenario-based written answer	2 hours	60%

3. CPAP examinations

After the foundation, the two written papers and the competency assessment may be attempted in any order.

ASSESSMENT	FORMAT	DURATION	PASS MARK
P1 Assurance Principles and Frameworks	Written answer and case questions	3 hours	50%
P2 Assurance Practice and Reporting	Written answer and worked review	3 hours	50%
C Competency Assessment	An assurance review and report on a set project case	Take-home	50%

4. Experience requirement

A candidate must evidence relevant assurance or closely cognate oversight experience, logged against the CPAP competencies and verified before certification. The experience must demonstrate independent review of projects or programmes, exercised with the objectivity the credential requires.

Experience is logged against the published competencies and verified by the Institute, with reference to employers or clients where appropriate, before any credential is conferred.

5. Syllabus modules

- Principles of independent assurance
- Assurance frameworks and gateway reviews
- Deliverability and delivery-confidence assessment
- Review of governance, controls, and risk
- Procurement integrity review
- Assurance planning, evidence, and reporting
- Independent advice to boards and funders
- Assurance in African procurement and finance

6. Examination regulations

- A mark of 70% or above is recorded as a distinction.
- A failed paper may be resat, with up to four attempts at any single paper.
- All examinations for the credential must be completed within five years of the first paper passed.
- Misconduct or misrepresentation may bar certification, and a credential obtained through it is withdrawn.

7. Keeping the credential: CPD

- A minimum of 35 hours of continuing professional development each year.
- At least 20 of those hours must be structured (courses, examined study, formal seminars or equivalent).
- Records are kept annually and a sample is audited. A credential not restored to good standing lapses.

> **Scope of the designation.** A holder does not assure a project in which they hold a delivery interest.

Source: AIPAF Credential Specification and Examination Framework, Edition 2026. For enquiries contact info@aipafgh.org · www.aipafgh.org